



Fast and furious



Bentley Speed 8 UK 2001



Le Mans 205 mph (330 km/h)

Rear wing deflects air to keep car stable

Aston Martin DBR9 UK 2005



Le Mans 186 mph (299 km/h)

Powerful headlights for nighttime racing



Audi R10 Germany 2006

Le Mans 211 mph (339 km/h)

Roll cage frame protects driver if car rolls over

BMW M3 GT2 Germany 2008



Le Mans 180 mph (290 km/h)

Radio transmitter sends information about the car's performance to race team



Ferrari F2008 Italy 2008

Powerful disk brakes can stop a car at 125 mph (200 km/h) in three seconds



Modern high-speed racers packed with electronics are designed and modeled on computers, and tested in wind tunnels to ensure their design offers maximum performance. No expense is spared on these sleek speed machines.

All successful race cars must be fast, but different forms of racing place different demands on the vehicle. A power-packed rally car must be rugged and able to handle roads, tracks, and rough ground. The World Championship winning Volkswagen WRC Polo R can accelerate from